AR 2EB

ALAMEDA RESEARCH
2: ELECTRIC BOOGALOO
LONG HORIZONS · STRUCTURAL SHIFTS · IMAGINATION

INTERNAL RESEARCH · MEMO · NOT INVESTMENT ADVICE · AI-ASSISTED

Joby Aviation

NYSE : JOBY · Young-Company DCF (Damodaran)

22 October 2026 · the qualitative

$4.64

$4.56B mkt cap · 984M sh · $2.5B cash, zero debt

THE CENTRAL QUESTION

Will Joby capture meaningful share of a $250B global UAM TAM by 2036 — or is today's ~$6.3B market cap pricing certainty that competitive eVTOL economics don't support?

Joby trades at ~$6.3B against $24M of Q1 2026 revenue and $700M annualized cash burn. The $2.5B cash position (post Feb 2026 $1.2B raise) provides ~3 years of runway. FAA certification entered Stage 5 (TIA) in March 2026 with the type certificate guided late 2026, Dubai exclusive operations begin in 2026, and the June 2026 Toyota manufacturing joint venture unlocks scale. Pre-revenue category-defining companies present a Damodaran problem: the standard 5-year DCF generates nonsense. The young-company framework asks what mature TAM share is plausible, what terminal margins look like at scale, and what probability of outright failure. Five scenarios, weighted; show your work.

PROBABILITY-WEIGHTED EXPECTED VALUE

most likely case (base) -21.3% · 85% at or below spot

$8.42

expected fair value today

+81.5% vs spot $4.64

FORWARD COMPOUNDED VALUE

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$12.16	$17.56	$25.38	$36.72
2.62× spot	3.78× spot	5.47× spot	7.91× spot

WEIGHTING RATIONALE

Ultra Bear 13% Deepest tail: heavier distressed dilution to survive; the $2.5B cash floor keeps it above zero.

Bear 17% Aerospace startups historically fail at high rates; for-credit testing routinely runs long.

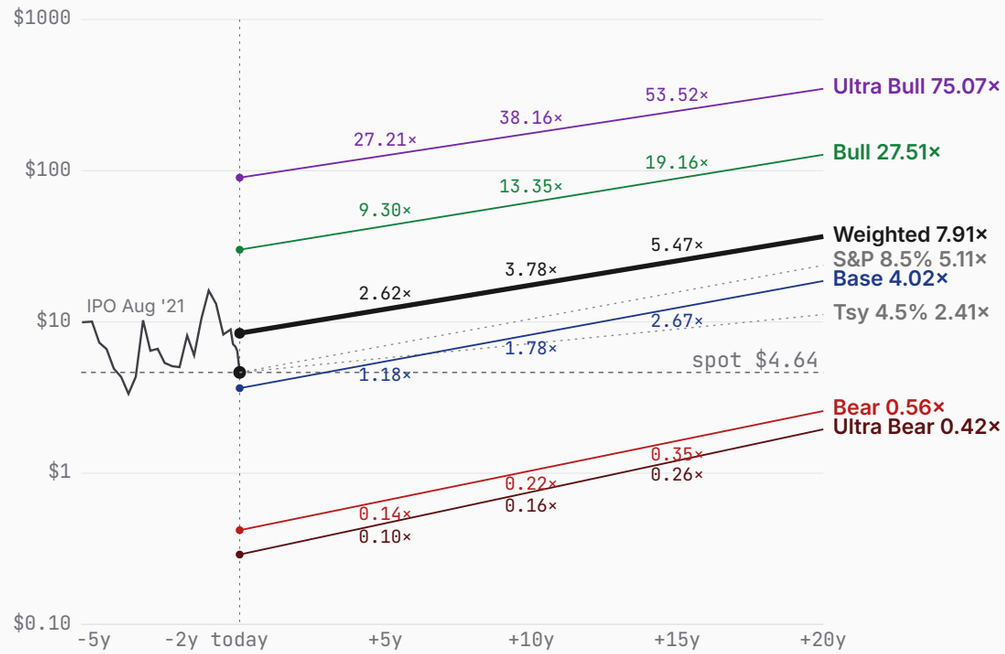
Base 55% Modal outcome: Joby + Archer split US with aerospace-blend margins.

Bull 12% Compound conditional chain; joint probability lands at 10-15% despite individually plausible pieces.

Ultra Bull 3% Tail of tails: dominant global UAM + early autonomous pivot + software-take-rate multiple expansion.

Bull (12%) + Ultra Bull (3%) together contribute $6.31 — 75% of the $8.42 expected value despite 15% combined probability. Today's spot ($4.64) sits 45% below the weighted expected.

PRICE + PROJECTIONS · HISTORICAL THROUGH PROBABILITY-WEIGHTED FORWARD



ULTRA BEAR — $0.29

-93.8% vs spot

TAM 0.3% P(fail) 48%
S2C 0.8 Prob 13%

eVTOL stalls; cash floors a thin value.

BEAR — $0.42

-90.9% vs spot

TAM 0.6% P(fail) 35%
S2C 0.8 Prob 17%

Cert delays; mfg stumbles; China wins.

BASE — $3.65

-21.3% vs spot

TAM 2.8% P(fail) 18%
S2C 1.2 Prob 55%

Joby + Archer split US; 13% margin.

BULL — $30.05

+547.6% vs spot

TAM 8.0% P(fail) 8%
S2C 1.6 Prob 12%

Western eVTOL leader; SaaS margins.

ULTRA BULL — $90.01

+1839.9% vs spot

TAM 16.0% P(fail) 4%
S2C 1.8 Prob 3%

Global UAM dominance; SaaS-take-rate.

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Joby Aviation scenario narratives

PROBABILITY WEIGHTS

Ultra Bear 13% Bear 17% Base 55% Bull 12% Ultra Bull 3% · Weighted expected $8.42 (+81.5% vs spot)

ULTRA BEAR $0.29

-93.8% vs spot

Probability 13%

eVTOL stalls; cash floors a thin value.

WHY 13%

The deepest-failure tail, split from the bear for book-wide consistency. 13% weight reflects genuine certification / manufacturing / unit-economics risk for pre-revenue eVTOL; distinct from the bear in that survival here demands heavier dilution. Within-scenario 48% p_fail; the large cash balance keeps even this tail above zero.

WHAT HAPPENS

The deepest tail: Joby's commercial eVTOL ramp stalls (~$0.82B by FY36) — certification, manufacturing yield or route economics disappoint and adoption never reaches scale, well below the bear's $1.5B niche.

Surviving the stall requires heavier, more dilutive capital than the bear: successive distressed raises take the share count to ~2.87B (from ~0.9B, ~69% dilution) versus the bear's ~1.5B. Operating EV stays negative with no self-sustaining FCF base.

BEAR $0.42

-90.9% vs spot

Probability 17%

Cert delays; mfg stumbles; China wins.

WHY 17%

Aerospace startups historically fail at high rates even with funding. SR3 audit timing has slipped industry-wide; TIA for-credit testing routinely extends 12-24 months beyond projections. Manufacturing scaling at Dayton is the hardest unproven part — Tesla took years on Model 3 with mature automotive suppliers. The 17% weight acknowledges that the $2.5B cash + Toyota manufacturing partnership materially reduce execution risk relative to a typical aerospace startup, but eVTOL unit economics remain fundamentally unproven at fleet scale. Even with strong execution, the category itself could fail to generate profitable demand. Within-scenario 35% p_fail captures Joby-specific bankruptcy; the 17% bear weight — with a further 13% ultra-bear split out beneath it — captures the broader 'bear world' where eVTOL economics don't scale even if Joby executes.

WHAT HAPPENS

The pessimistic case is brutal for eVTOL economics. FAA Type Certification slips from 2026 into 2027 or later — Stage 5 (TIA) was entered in March 2026, but for-credit FAA testing has historically taken longer than companies project. The Dubai launch is real but on a single route; volume builds slowly. Manufacturing in Dayton scales below the 4-aircraft/month target.

Cash burn continues at $700M+ annualized. The $2.5B cash position lasts ~3 years, but commercial scaling requires far more capital. By FY30 Joby has raised another $2-3B at progressively lower prices, diluting holders 50%+. Aerospace economics don't reach software-like margins — at scale operating margin tops out around 5%, similar to legacy regional aviation operators.

BASE $3.65

-21.3% vs spot

Probability 55%

Joby + Archer split US; 13% margin.

WHY 55%

Modal outcome given de-risking factors already in place. FAA Type Cert progresses on schedule or slightly delayed; Toyota manufacturing scales incrementally rather than to full 500-aircraft/year; Dubai launches commercially but stays limited in scope; Joby and Archer effectively split the US market based on funding/partnership advantages. The 55% weight reflects that the base case requires the LEAST faith — no breakthrough business model, no dominant competitive position, no breakthrough regulatory cooperation. Just sequential execution on plans largely in motion. Result: real revenue with aerospace-blend operating margins (~13%, peer-set median between regional aviation at 8% and ADAS software at 30%), well below the software-economics framing implicit in today's market cap. Joby reaches commercial scale; the open question is at what margin.

WHAT HAPPENS

The middle path. FAA Type Certification comes through in late 2026 / early 2027. Joby's Dubai exclusivity through 2032 anchors Middle East revenue, US operations via the eIPP program scale through 2027-28, and the Toyota partnership delivers manufacturing scale at the Dayton facility. By FY36, ~1,400 aircraft and $7B revenue at 13% operating margin.

But the market splinters. Archer is the credible #2 in the US. EHang dominates China. Joby captures 2.8% of $250B global UAM TAM — meaningful but not dominant. Mature 13% operating margin reflects aerospace economics: better than legacy carriers (5-8%) but well below software (25%+). This is what the Damodaran framework produces with defensible peer-set anchors.

BULL $30.05

+547.6% vs spot

Probability 12%

Western eVTOL leader; SaaS margins.

WHY 12%

The bull case requires a chain of conditional events: FAA Type Cert on schedule by end-2026 AND Toyota Dayton scales to full 500-aircraft/year capacity by 2028-29 AND Dubai exclusivity template replicates in 3+ countries (Saudi Arabia, India, SE Asia) AND competition narrows (Archer ships meaningfully lower volumes, EHang stays regional to China) AND autonomous flight matures within 5-7 years AND Joby successfully pivots to software-take-rate model on partner aircraft. Even granting 60-70% probability per condition with correlation (i.e., if cert works Toyota probably scales), joint probability lands closer to 10-15%. Conjunctive probability is one of the most reliably underestimated quantities in forecasting — the bull case isn't blocked by any single piece looking unlikely, but by compound dependency. 15% reflects that this is a real possibility, just not central.

WHAT HAPPENS

The bull case is that Joby becomes the dominant Western eVTOL operator and manufacturer. FAA Type Certification on schedule in 2026 unlocks rapid scaling. The Toyota manufacturing partnership delivers the Dayton facility at full 500-aircraft/year capacity by FY28-29. Dubai exclusivity becomes a template — Joby wins similar long-term operating contracts in Saudi Arabia, India, and Southeast Asia.

Competition narrows. Archer ships but at lower volumes. EHang remains regional to China. By FY36 Joby operates 4,000 aircraft, generates $20B revenue, and captures 8% of $250B global UAM TAM. As autonomous flight capability matures (5-7 years away), Joby pivots to a software-take-rate model on partner-operated aircraft, reaching software-like margins. Mature operating margin reaches 28%.

ULTRA BULL $90.01

+1839.9% vs spot

Probability 3%

Global UAM dominance; SaaS-take-rate.

WHY 3%

Tail of tails: requires every Bull condition to hit AND multiple expansion AND replicate internationally AND early autonomous pivot. Each individually 60-75% probable; joint at 3-5%. Genuine tail captures the scenario where Joby joins the software-aerospace-hybrid giants club.

WHAT HAPPENS

The ultra-bull case is that Joby becomes the dominant global UAM platform — not just Western leader. FAA cert on schedule + Toyota Dayton scales + Dubai template replicates in 5+ countries + autonomous flight matures within 5-7 years + Joby pivots successfully to a software-take-rate model on partner-operated aircraft + multiple expansion to aerospace/software-hybrid premium. By FY36 Joby operates 8,000+ aircraft globally, captures 16% of $250B UAM TAM, and software-take-rate revenue dominates with 35%+ mature margins.

Compound conditional: each piece individually plausible at 60-75%; joint at 3-5%. Reflected here at 3%. This is the genuine tail — not a 'mild upside,' but the scenario where Joby joins the aerospace/software giants club. Contributes $2.70 to the $8.42 weighted expected ($90 × 3%).

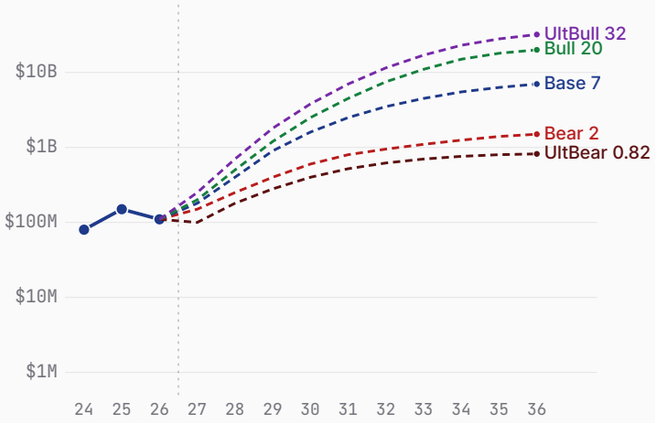
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Joby Aviation business snapshot

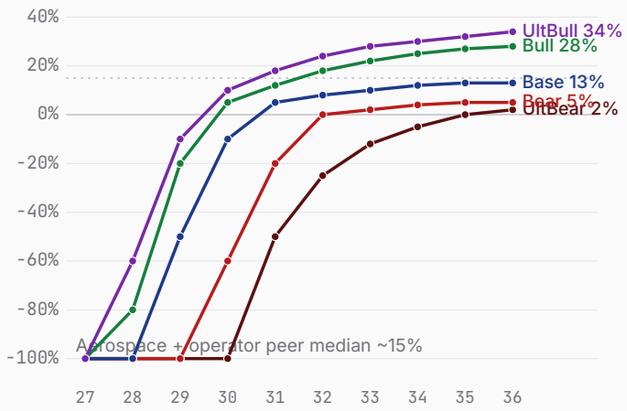
Bear $0.42 Base $3.65 Bull $30.05

FY24–FY26 history + FY27–FY36 scenario projections · fiscal years end Dec 31 · 10-K, Q1 2026 10-Q, Morgan Stanley UAM

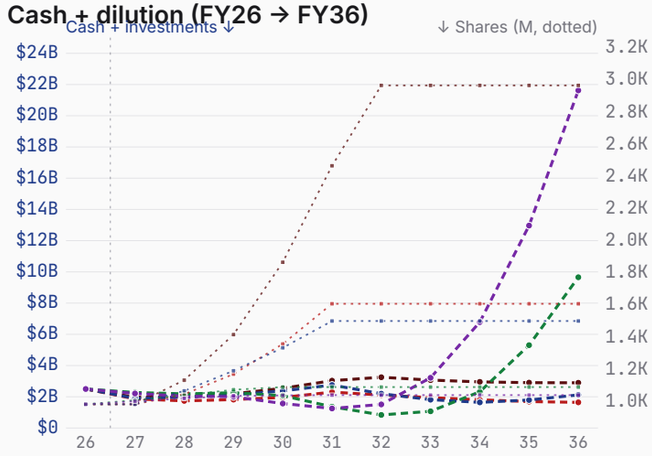
Revenue — history + scenarios to FY36 (log)



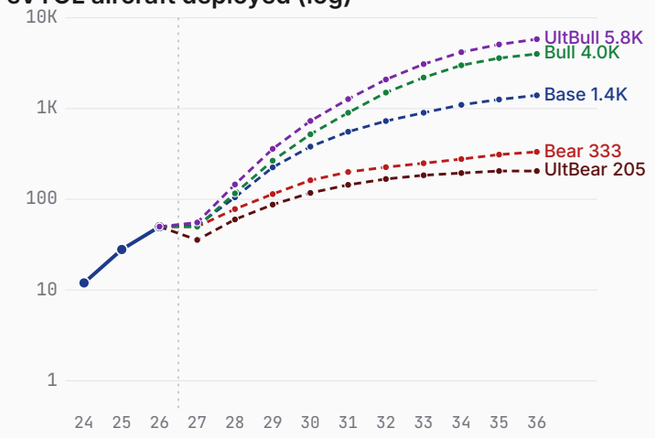
Path to profitability — op margin (FY27→FY36)



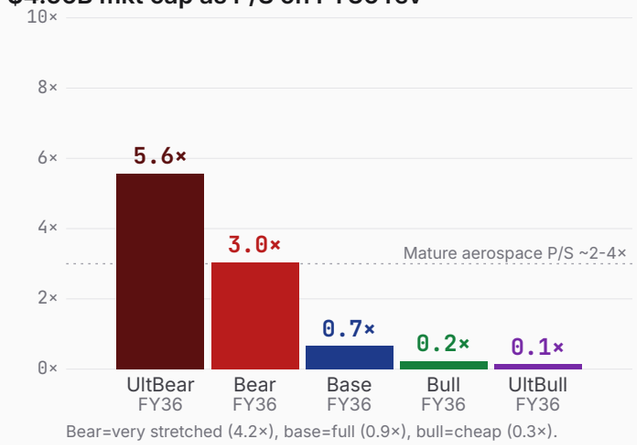
Cash + dilution (FY26 → FY36)



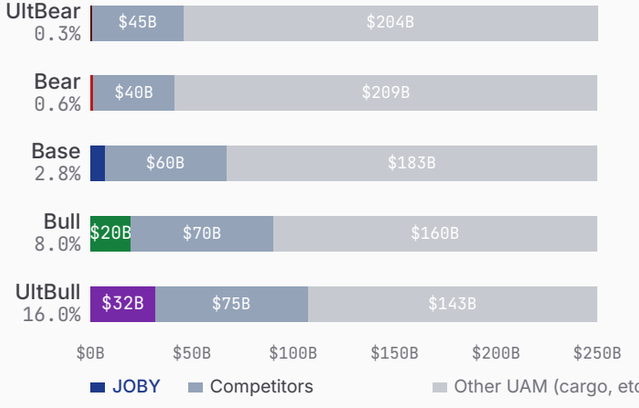
eVTOL aircraft deployed (log)



$4.56B mkt cap as P/S on FY36 rev



$250B global UAM TAM (FY36) — Joby share



Sources: JOBY 10-K FY25, Q1 2026 10-Q, Morgan Stanley UAM TAM Update (Global $1T by 2040; ~$250B FY36 interpolation).

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Joby Aviation 7 Powers · the moat, scored

Bear $0.42 Base $3.65 Bull $30.05

Arena. eVTOL / advanced air mobility — Joby vs Archer, Beta, Vertical Aerospace, Eve/Embraer; the race to FAA type certification and commercial air-taxi service.

POWER ORIGINATION
origination window: open

POWER ORIGINATION · 7 POWERS

Scale Economies	Manufacturing scale years away; unit economics unproven.
Network Economies	Eventual moat, not yet originated: Dubai VDX vertiport certified Jul 2026 (Joby-exclusive market) — but the ACES 250-site US charging consortium (Archer + Beta, Jul 2026) is forming without Joby.
Counter-Positioning	Vertically integrated OEM-plus-operator model legacy aero/airlines can't easily copy.
Switching Costs	No installed base yet; future pilot/fleet lock-in.
Branding	Joby + Toyota/Delta halo; acquired Uber Elevate brand.
Cornered Resource · thesis leans here	Toyota joint venture (Jun 2026) formalizes exclusive S4 manufacturing — deeper barrier, 51% control ceded; Delta tie-up; Virgin Atlantic exclusive UK partnership (Jul 2026); FAA cert lead; powertrain IP — contested by Archer's ITC complaint (allegation, not adjudication; Joby's parallel trade-secret suit survived while Archer's entire countersuit was dismissed, Jun 2026).
Process Power	Manufacturing learning curve just beginning.

THE RACE · NAMED RIVALS

Archer Aviation — well-funded; Stellantis

~20% terminal share · United + Stellantis + US Army; behind on FAA track; first UAE RTC (May 2026) — limited Abu Dhabi ops possible in 2026; filed ITC Section 337 complaint alleging Joby's imported power-system components infringe five Archer patents (instituted Apr 2026; final determination ~Sept 2027).

Beta Technologies — ~$1B post-IPO

~12% terminal share · Cargo/eCTOL first; selected in 7 of the 8 eIPP launch projects (Mar 2026) — most of any developer, including Joby; first eIPP operational flights Jul 2026 (organs, with United Therapeutics); building a charging network.

Vertical Aerospace — constrained

~8% terminal share · UK; VX4; smaller balance sheet.

Eve (Embraer) — Embraer-backed

~10% terminal share · OEM heritage + order book; later to fly.

LEAD / LAG · FALSIFIERS

FAA type certification stage	Stage 5 (TIA) since Mar 2026; for-credit flying pending vs Archer: 100% MoC accepted Jan 2026; behind on FAA track	LEADING
Manufacturing partner	Toyota vs Stellantis	EVEN
Cash runway (yrs at burn)	3 vs 2	LEADING

COMPETITIVE READ

Joby leads on certification progress and a Toyota-backed capital/manufacturing position, but the network-economics moat is unoriginated and Archer is close; the window stays open through type certification — the gating falsifier for the whole category.

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Joby Aviation show your work

Bear $0.42 Base $3.65 Bull $30.05 · Weighted $8.42 (+81.5%)

ULTRA BEAR $0.29

ASSUMPTIONS

TAM Year-10 ($B)	250
Mature share (%)	0.3
Mature op margin (%)	2
Sales-to-capital	0.8
Terminal WACC (%)	10.0
Terminal growth (%)	2.0
P(failure) (%)	48
Scenario probability (%)	13

10-YEAR DCF · $B

FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY27	0.10	-400%	-0.23	-0.20
FY28	0.18	-280%	-0.60	-0.46
FY29	0.28	-180%	-0.63	-0.42
FY30	0.40	-100%	-0.55	-0.33
FY31	0.52	-50%	-0.41	-0.22
FY32	0.62	-25%	-0.28	-0.13
FY33	0.70	-12%	-0.18	-0.08
FY34	0.76	-5%	-0.11	-0.04
FY35	0.80	+0%	-0.05	-0.02
FY36	0.82	+2%	-0.01	-0.00

Σ PV explicit FCF	**-1.91**
+ PV terminal (g 2.0%)	-0.04

EQUITY BUILD · $B & PER SHARE

Operating EV	$-1.95B
+ Cash & investments	$2.50B
= Equity value	**$0.55B**
Raised over period	$3.75B
Dilution by FY36	+69%
FY36 shares (M)	2,866
DCF per share	**$0.19**
× (1−P_fail) [52%]	$0.10
+ P_fail × distress [48% × $0.40]	$0.19

= Expected per share $0.29

FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$0.47	$0.75	$1.21	$1.95
0.10×	0.16×	0.26×	0.42×

BEAR $0.42

ASSUMPTIONS

TAM Year-10 ($B)	250
Mature share (%)	0.6
Mature op margin (%)	5
Sales-to-capital	0.8
Terminal WACC (%)	9.5
Terminal growth (%)	2.0
P(failure) (%)	35
Scenario probability (%)	17

10-YEAR DCF · $B

FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY27	0.15	-300%	-0.50	-0.44
FY28	0.25	-200%	-0.63	-0.48
FY29	0.40	-120%	-0.67	-0.46
FY30	0.60	-60%	-0.61	-0.37
FY31	0.80	-20%	-0.41	-0.22
FY32	0.95	+0%	-0.19	-0.09
FY33	1.10	+2%	-0.17	-0.07
FY34	1.25	+4%	-0.14	-0.05
FY35	1.40	+5%	-0.12	-0.04
FY36	1.50	+5%	-0.05	-0.02

Σ PV explicit FCF	**-2.25**
+ PV terminal (g 2.0%)	0.32

EQUITY BUILD · $B & PER SHARE

Operating EV	$-1.93B
+ Cash & investments	$2.50B
= Equity value	**$0.57B**
Raised over period	$2.75B
Dilution by FY36	+53%
FY36 shares (M)	1,508
DCF per share	**$0.38**
× (1−P_fail) [65%]	$0.25
+ P_fail × distress [35% × $0.50]	$0.17

= Expected per share $0.42

FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$0.66	$1.04	$1.64	$2.58
0.14×	0.22×	0.35×	0.56×

BASE $3.65

ASSUMPTIONS

TAM Year-10 ($B)	250
Mature share (%)	2.8
Mature op margin (%)	13
Sales-to-capital	1.2
Terminal WACC (%)	8.5
Terminal growth (%)	2.5
P(failure) (%)	18
Scenario probability (%)	55

10-YEAR DCF · $B

FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY27	0.18	-250%	-0.51	-0.45
FY28	0.40	-120%	-0.66	-0.52
FY29	0.90	-50%	-0.87	-0.61
FY30	1.60	-10%	-0.74	-0.47
FY31	2.50	+5%	-0.63	-0.35
FY32	3.50	+8%	-0.61	-0.31
FY33	4.50	+10%	-0.48	-0.22
FY34	5.50	+12%	-0.31	-0.13
FY35	6.30	+13%	-0.02	-0.01
FY36	7.00	+13%	+0.14	+0.05

Σ PV explicit FCF	**-3.03**
+ PV terminal (g 2.5%)	6.10

EQUITY BUILD · $B & PER SHARE

Operating EV	$3.07B
+ Cash & investments	$2.50B
= Equity value	**$5.57B**
Raised over period	$3.75B
Dilution by FY36	+31%
FY36 shares (M)	1,284
DCF per share	**$4.34**
× (1−P_fail) [82%]	$3.56
+ P_fail × distress [18% × $0.50]	$0.09

= Expected per share $3.65

FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$5.49	$8.25	$12.41	$18.66
1.18×	1.78×	2.67×	4.02×

BULL $30.05

ASSUMPTIONS

TAM Year-10 ($B)	250
Mature share (%)	8.0
Mature op margin (%)	28
Sales-to-capital	1.6
Terminal WACC (%)	7.5
Terminal growth (%)	3.0
P(failure) (%)	8
Scenario probability (%)	12

10-YEAR DCF · $B

FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY27	0.20	-200%	-0.46	-0.41
FY28	0.50	-80%	-0.59	-0.46
FY29	1.20	-20%	-0.68	-0.48
FY30	2.50	+5%	-0.69	-0.43
FY31	4.50	+12%	-0.71	-0.40
FY32	7.50	+18%	-0.53	-0.26
FY33	11.00	+22%	+0.23	+0.10
FY34	15.00	+25%	+1.25	+0.53
FY35	18.00	+27%	+2.98	+1.17
FY36	20.00	+28%	+4.35	+1.59

Σ PV explicit FCF	**+0.94**
+ PV terminal (g 3.0%)	32.10

EQUITY BUILD · $B & PER SHARE

Operating EV	$33.04B
+ Cash & investments	$2.50B
= Equity value	**$35.54B**
Raised over period	$2.05B
Dilution by FY36	+11%
FY36 shares (M)	1,091
DCF per share	**$32.58**
× (1−P_fail) [92%]	$29.97
+ P_fail × distress [8% × $1.00]	$0.08

= Expected per share $30.05

FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$43.14	$61.93	$88.91	$127.65
9.30×	13.35×	19.16×	27.51×

ULTRA BULL $90.01

ASSUMPTIONS

TAM Year-10 ($B)	250
Mature share (%)	16.0
Mature op margin (%)	34
Sales-to-capital	1.8
Terminal WACC (%)	7.0
Terminal growth (%)	3.5
P(failure) (%)	4
Scenario probability (%)	3

10-YEAR DCF · $B

FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY27	0.25	-180%	-0.52	-0.47
FY28	0.70	-60%	-0.68	-0.55
FY29	1.80	-10%	-0.84	-0.62
FY30	3.80	+10%	-0.88	-0.58
FY31	7.00	+18%	-0.69	-0.42
FY32	11.50	+24%	+0.06	+0.03
FY33	17.00	+28%	+1.89	+0.93
FY34	23.00	+30%	+4.10	+1.85
FY35	28.00	+32%	+6.96	+2.88
FY36	32.00	+34%	+9.63	+3.67

Σ PV explicit FCF	**+6.73**
+ PV terminal (g 3.5%)	95.83

EQUITY BUILD · $B & PER SHARE

Operating EV	$102.56B
+ Cash & investments	$2.50B
= Equity value	**$105.06B**
Raised over period	$2.05B
Dilution by FY36	+11%
FY36 shares (M)	1,121
DCF per share	**$93.72**
× (1−P_fail) [96%]	$89.97
+ P_fail × distress [4% × $0.96]	$0.04

= Expected per share $90.01

FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT

+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
$126.24	$177.06	$248.34	$348.31
27.21×	38.16×	53.52×	75.07×

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Joby Aviation People · Opportunity · Context · Deal

Bear $0.42 Base $3.65 Bull $30.05

Underwrite the position the way a venture investor underwrites a round — across all four legs, public or private. **People** is the leg scored here (observable only); Opportunity, Context and Deal cross-reference the rest of the memo.

PEOPLE · WHO RUNS / OWNS / FUNDS IT

JoeBen Bevirt · `founder-led` — 17 yrs in seat

9.4%
insider ownership

MEDIUM
key-person risk

Capital allocation (realized)
Founder JoeBen Bevirt has been CEO since founding Joby in 2009. Pre-revenue eVTOL developer: ~$2.5B cash at Q1 2026 against a ~$160M/quarter burn, funded by equity, convertible and ATM issuance (~$1.3B raised in Q1 2026) plus Toyota's ~$894M of cumulative strategic investment — the second $250M tranche of Toyota's Oct 2024 $500M commitment is not yet closed, expected Q4 2026, conditioned on final approval of a JV manufacturing supply agreement. In June 2026 manufacturing moved into a Toyota-majority joint venture (Toyota 51% / Joby 49%) holding exclusive S4-series production rights. FAA type certification is in Stage 5 (TIA); a type certificate is targeted for late 2026. No dividend or buyback (cash is preserved for certification and launch).

Incentive alignment
Bevirt's FY2025 compensation was ~$3.7M with no cash bonus (a cash-preservation policy pays short-term incentives in RSUs), under a 5x-salary ownership guideline and strict anti-hedging/anti-pledging rules. He is aligned via a ~9-12% economic stake (co-founder Paul Sciarra holds another ~5.7%). Insider activity is programmatic 10b5-1 selling, no open-market buying; the company also leases office space from Bevirt-owned entities (~$0.6M/year).

GOVERNANCE FLAGS

- single class of common stock, one vote per share — no super-voting; the founder's influence tracks his ~9-12% economic stake (notably cleaner than dual-class eVTOL peer Archer)
- Chair and CEO are separated, but the Executive Chairman (co-founder Sciarra) is non-independent — independent oversight runs through the lead independent director (Michael Huerta, former FAA Administrator)
- classified / staggered board (three classes) — an entrenchment feature
- Toyota is simultaneously the largest outside shareholder (13.1% per its June 2026 13D/A), holds a contractual board seat (Ogawa), is a key component supplier, and — via the June 2026 joint venture (51% Toyota, 3 of 5 JV board seats, exclusive S4-series manufacturing rights, royalty-free license to Joby manufacturing IP) — majority-controls Joby's manufacturing; concentration plus deep related-party complexity
- founder-CEO related-party: office space leased from Bevirt-owned entities (~$0.6M/year)
- pre-revenue, funded by ongoing equity and convertible dilution

THE FOUR LEGS

People — observable composite · 1–5 ●●●●○

Opportunity
The scenario distribution · the business snapshot

Context
The 7 Powers analysis (Power Origination)

Deal
Open-market common — entry price weighed against the probability-weighted fair value of the scenario set + position sizing. `+81.5% vs spot $4.64`

PEOPLE READ

Structurally the cleanest of the frontier names: one share, one vote (no founder super-voting), a chair separated from the CEO, a credentialed lead independent director (a former FAA Administrator), a 6-of-9 independent board, and strict anti-hedging/ownership rules. That separation and clean share class are why it scores above combined-Chair/CEO peer Archer. The offsets that keep it from a 5 are a classified board, a founder-related-party office lease, and Toyota's quadruple role as top shareholder, director, supplier and — since the June 2026 joint venture — majority owner of Joby's manufacturing. Key-person risk is moderate — real founder dependence, but leadership is shared with an executive co-founder.

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Joby Aviation supporting analysis · disclaimers · glossary

Bear $0.42 Base $3.65 Bull $30.05

PUSHBACK · WHY THE BASE CASE IS TOO HARSH

1 **Type Cert is imminent.**
Stage 5 (TIA) entered March 2026; conforming aircraft flying since March 11. For-credit FAA testing pending; certificate guided late 2026.

2 **Best capitalized eVTOL.**
$2.5B cash exceeds Archer ($1.8B) and Vertical (+$850M raise). Multi-year runway through commercial scaling.

3 **Partnership stack is unique.**
Toyota ($894M, mfg), Delta ($200M, US), Dubai RTA (to 2032). No other eVTOL has this stack; Delta warned (May 2026) the ITC case could threaten it.

4 **Operator + mfg = wider moat.**
Joby owns/operates fleet rather than selling aircraft. Captures full revenue per flight, not just OEM margin.

5 **Mature margin may be conservative.**
Base case 13% reflects aerospace blend. If software-take-rate on partner aircraft scales, terminal margin could be 20%+.

FALSIFICATION TRIGGERS

Bear validation

Type Cert slips to 2027+ · Cash < $1.5B by EOY 2026 · Toyota's 2nd $250M tranche not closed by YE 2026 · Dubai volume < 50K rides FY27 · Archer ITC case: adverse ALJ ruling May 2027, or exclusion order ~Sept 2027

Bull validation

Type Cert achieved by Q3 2026 · Dayton facility hits 4 aircraft/month · Second Dubai-style market-exclusive operating award (airline exclusives, e.g. Virgin Atlantic Jul 2026, are adjacent — not this)

Reframe needed

If Archer achieves FAA Type Certification first — Joby's US first-mover advantage erodes; share-of-TAM math compresses. Archer flying UAE passengers under its RTC alone does not trip this.

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GLOSSARY · CONCEPTS REFERENCED IN THE NARRATIVE

eVTOL — Electric Vertical Take-Off and Landing aircraft. Joby's S4 is a 5-seat, 6-rotor design with ~100-mile range.

Type Certification — FAA approval to operate a new aircraft design commercially. Joby entered Stage 5 (TIA) of the 5-stage process in March 2026; certificate guided late 2026.

eIPP — eVTOL Integration Pilot Program. White House-backed initiative letting Joby fly in US states pre-Type Cert.

Dubai RTA — Roads & Transport Authority. Awarded Joby exclusive eVTOL air-taxi rights in Dubai through 2032.

Toyota partnership — ~$894M invested; second $250M tranche expected Q4 2026, pending a final JV supply agreement. June 2026 joint venture (Toyota 51%) holds exclusive S4 manufacturing rights at Dayton, Ohio.

Blade — Helicopter-based mobility business acquired in 2024 — gives Joby existing routes (NYC-airport) for early ops.